Midterm Question for Spring 2026 HUM 101—

https://www.smithsonianmag.com/history/fall-roman-republic-income-inequality-and-xenophobia-threatened-its-foundations-180967249/

https://drive.google.com/file/d/18clPtP91TdR1btNAOvvLZMEC-9YF8isO/view?usp=sharing

pages 187-197

Read the case study of the two above-mentioned materials, the first discussing about the presence of elite senatorial domination within the Roman Republic's (**509 BCE to 27 BCE)** political and economic system, and the second discussing on the Chinese concept of *min ben* (people as the root) particularly gaining relevance during the Chinese Warring States Period (**475 BCE to 221 BCE)** which echoes the famous Confucian idea that the common people must be governed well and their well-being ensured, but they should not be asked on how they should be governed and their opinion cannot be taken as a political guideline.

Provide an analysis on to what extent both monarchy and non-monarchical systems of government are attempting to "control" the people by political and economic means? How political institutions that created administrative structures of control, and ideologies determined who was included as a legitimate political actor and who was excluded; the degree to which each system genuinely empowered parts of the population versus preserved authority for a narrow group.

Provide an analytical argument for why this control was necessary, and do you see this control taking place in your society/ other societies in the present time. Do you think political

ideologies shape public perceptions and justify the medium of governance for the mass? If so, how much do you think the mass people contribute towards establishing systems of governance in the ancient world? Write an analytically argumentative essay within the 1500-to-2500-word range limit. Do not exceed 2500 words including the quotations and paraphrases. Bibliography and other citation information is excluded from the 2500-word limit.

Do not plagiarize. Provide proper in text citation in terms of quotations and paraphrases using MLA 7th edition format. AI Form will be provided to the students who will be using AI. Discussion on the AI form will be discussed by the course instructors

Midterm Submission Instructions:

Composition Instruction: Times New Roman, Font Size 12, 1.5 line spacing No Hard Copy Required.

Upload a pdf file on turnitin

Upload pdf files on Turnitin. While submitting the file name should be organized as follows: Student ID_Name_HUM 101 SP'26

***MULTIPLE SUBMISSIONS ARE DISCOURAGED DUE TO UNACKNOWLEDGED SPIKES IN TURNITIN'S PLAGIARISM RATES**

Due Date- 28/03/2026 by 11:00 pm

*All texts and other sources we have used for class discussion on China and Roman Republic (primarily chapter 7 and 9 from Antony Black's *World History of Ancient Political Thought*) in addition to other chapters from the book should be used. Also, if required you can use other texts we have covered in class for discussion of theme 2.

In addition to that, all students must use at least two and a maximum of five **scholarly secondary sources** to support their analytical commentary. **Three to five direct quotations from scholarly sources must be used, with proper in text citation format, along with paraphrases.**

Information of our Teaching Assistant who will help you with essay outline, improving on your thesis statement, and in text citation and bibliography format: suhaina.hadi@bracu.ac.bd

Please book a consultation with her before the Eid holidays and learn everything related to in text citation format and bibliography page.

Sources covered in class discussions and facilitations:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Zo4L3HFlhCL0BVoYVflZK76IfjsHj4xQ/view?usp=sharing selections from chapter 7, 8 and 9

Supplementary Readings on the position of women of ancient China and Rome:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1M-wjByCiSqs0Aa7tl12v3KykdB4exHOr/view?usp=sharing selections from chapter 6.2 and 6.3, and 7.3 and 7.4

Rubric of the midterm: TOTAL MARKS 20

Structure of the essay: Introduction with a thesis statement, 2 to 3 body paragraphs, and a conclusion- 2 marks

Quality and in-depth analysis of the body paragraphs (proper selection of information with in text cited paraphrases; developing appropriate quality analysis and author's commentary backed by scholarly secondary sources for two body paragraphs- it is recommended that there are no more than two to three body paragraphs)- 8 marks

Completion of the AI form- 1 marks (If students are not using AI then they will write they did not use AI in the AI Form) Submitting the AI form is mandatory and this will be submitted to our shared google drive. I will open a folder to submit the AI form

Mandatory visit to the Teaching Assistant- 2 marks

Selection of good scholarly secondary sources and using appropriate portions (quotations and paraphrases) from the secondary sources- 5 marks

Proper integration of classroom materials- 2 marks